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2025

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10 dead as truck rams into revellers in US

INVESTIGATORS FIND DAESH FLAG IN ATTACKER'S VEHICLE



AFP

Police investigators surround a white pickup truck that crashed into a work lift in the French Quarter of New Orleans after hitting several people yesterday.

NEW ORLEANS

A US citizen with a Daesh flag and "hellbent" on carnage slammed a pickup truck into a crowd of New Year revelers in New Orleans yesterday, killing at least 10 people and wounding more than 35, officials said.

The FBI identified the attacker as Shamsud Din Jabbar, a 42-year-old "US citizen from Texas."

"A Daesh flag was located in the vehicle, and the FBI is working to determine the subject's potential associations and affiliations with terrorist organisations," the FBI said in a statement.

"We do not believe that Jabbar was solely responsible," said FBI special agent Alethea Duncan.

The suspect was fatally shot in an exchange of gunfire with police. Potential homemade

bombs were found in his truck and around the Louisiana city's famed French Quarter, the FBI said.

Local police said the incident took place at around 3.15 am (0915 GMT) in the heart of the French Quarter, which was packed with people celebrating the start of 2025.

Carnage

"This man was trying to run over as many people as he possibly could," Police Superintendent Anne Kirkpatrick told reporters.

Driving at "very high

35

hurt as the vehicle
ploughed into a
New Year crowd

speed" and in a "very intentional" manner, "he was hellbent on creating the carnage and the damage that he did," Kirkpatrick said. He wounded two officers in the subsequent shootout but they were listed in stable condition.

The vehicle used was a white Ford F-150 electric pick-up, an AFP correspondent on the scene said.

President Joe Biden called New Orleans Mayor LaToya Cantrell "to offer full federal support following the horrific news," the White House said.

"There is no justification for violence of any kind, and we will not tolerate any attack on any of our nation's communities," Biden said in a statement.

President-elect Donald Trump immediately linked the attack to illegal immigration, giving no evidence and before authorities made clear the suspect was American. —AFP

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Dubai enforces ban on single-use plastics

Styrofoam, straws, and more products prohibited with start of New Year

DUBAI

BY ZAINAB HUSAIN

Features Writer

Dubai yesterday officially implemented a ban on single-use plastic products, including Styrofoam cups and food containers, plastic straws, and more. The move is part of the city's ongoing efforts to reduce plastic waste and promote sustainability.

A ban on single-use plastic bags is already in place since June 2024, following a resolution by Shaikh Hamdan Bin Mohammad Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister of Defence, and Chairman of the Executive Council of Dubai.

Eco-friendly lifestyle

The Executive Council Resolution No.124 of 2023 on single-use products aims to protect

the environment, encourage people to adopt an eco-friendly lifestyle, and promote a culture of using reusable products to advance sustainable development.

Phased approach

The resolution introduces a phased approach to halt the use of single-use plastics in Dubai. In January 2024, a 25 fils tariff was imposed on single-use plastics, followed by a ban on all single-use plastic bags in June of the same year.

In 2025, the ban extends to other single-use plastic products, specifically targeting Styrofoam containers and cups. By 2026, the ban will be expanded to include plastic plates, food containers, tableware, and beverage cups with plastic lids.

SEE ALSO P2

**In January 2024, a 25
fils tariff was imposed
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all single-use plastic
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SPORT

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UAE welcomes first batch of Generation Beta babies

2025 marks the beginning of a new era of humanity

DUBAI

BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN

Chief Reporter

A new era has begun as the UAE and the rest of the world welcomed Generation Beta, babies born between 2025 and 2039. This generation will navigate an increasingly digitised and interconnected world, inheriting challenges such as climate change, AI ethics, and evolving socio-political dynamics. Representing adaptive innovation and global interconnectedness, Generation Beta follows Generation Alpha (2013–2024), who were the first to be born in the 21st century and grew up immersed in advanced technology.

Generational naming began with Baby Boomers (1946–1964), characterised by post-war economic growth. They were suc-

ceeded by Generation X (1965–1980), Millennials (1981–1996), and Generation Z (1997–2012), each shaped by unique cultural and technological shifts. After Generation Beta, those born between 2040 and 2054 will be known as Generation Gamma.

At the stroke of midnight on January 1, UAE hospitals celebrated the arrival of Generation Beta's first members. Baby girls were born at 12.01am in three Abu Dhabi hospitals to Emirati, Indian, and Filipino parents. A hospital in Fujairah welcomed two Beta babies at 12.01am and 12.02am.

Similar joyful moments occurred in Dubai, Fujairah, Sharjah, and Ras Al Khaimah, with hospitals reporting the births of boys and girls to families of various nationalities in the wee hours.

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